

■ **VIDEO MEETINGS**

Google adds hand gestures recognition to Meet

Google has announced a new feature for its video communication service Google Meet. With this new feature, users can now raise their physical hand and Meet will recognise

it with gesture detection. "Until now, raising your hand to ask a question in Google Meet is done by clicking the hand-raise icon. Starting today, you can also raise your physical hand and Meet will recognise it with gesture detection," the tech giant announced in a Workspace Updates blogpost on November 21. To ensure the gesture is detected, make sure that the camera is enabled and your hand is visible to the camera, away from your face and body.

The new gesture detection feature is available for Google Workspace Business Plus, Business Standard, Enterprise Essentials, Enterprise Plus, Enterprise Standard, Enterprise Starter, Education Plus, the Teaching and Learning Upgrade customers, and Google Workspace Individual subscribers. It is currently rolling out. <https://bit.ly/3GCbzYV>

■ **TECH FOR RELIEF**

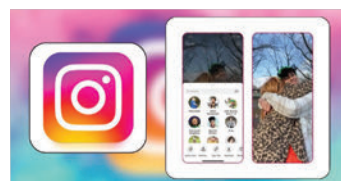
Drones help restore network connectivity in Sikkim

Sikkim was hit by a devastating flood in October this year, causing severe distress and destruction. A lot of critical infrastructure suffered during the flood. The flood also caused a lot of places to be out of network as network connectivity was lost and many facilities were out of service. The communication services were disrupted and various key players stepped in to restore the same in the affected regions. Telecom provider Airtel, a major service provider in the affected areas of Sikkim, noted how the floods had a major impact on its fibre optic network. This meant that users in affected areas were unable to use services. The drones were sent out to conduct aerial surveys and they assessed damages to fibre optic lines. This data was then used by engineers to figure out the exact location of the damages and then eventually make plans for the repairs. The precision and speed with which the IG Drones worked, helped in facilitating timely repairs and the rapid restoration of the fibre optic network. <https://bit.ly/3NhyUCP>



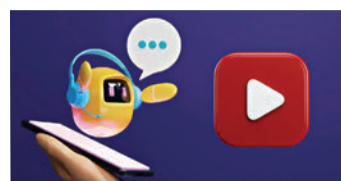
ChatGPT voice feature now available for all

OpenAI has announced that ChatGPT with voice feature is now available to all free users. This feature was first announced in September and was only available to Plus and Enterprise users.



Instagram now lets you download Reels

Meta-owned Instagram introduced a Reels download feature for users in the US earlier this year. Now, the company is rolling out this to all users. This means that you can now download Reels created by public accounts to your camera roll.



Google Bard can now answer queries about YouTube videos

Google has added a new feature to Bard. This feature enables users to ask questions from Bard about YouTube videos. For those who are unaware, Bard is an AI chatbot which Google launched earlier this year. Google announced this on Bard's 'Experiment updates' page.